

Pre-Lecture Analysis Sheet

Week 4 · Tongue Diagnosis 舌診 — Body Color, Shape, Coating, Moisture & Spirit
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How to use this sheet:

Before lecture → complete Sections A-D and the pre-lecture case questions. Rate your confidence honestly.

During lecture → annotate directly — add answers, corrections, and new insights in the lined spaces.

After lecture → complete Section F, update confidence ratings, and finish the clinical case.

EAM310

Week 4

Summer 2026

A Learning Targets — I Can Statements

Rate your confidence **before** lecture (Pre) and **after** lecture (Post) by circling a number 1-5 in each column. 1 = can't do it yet · 5 = fully confident

I Can Statement	Pre-Lecture Confidence	Post-Lecture Confidence
Name the four main aspects of tongue observation (plus Spirit) and state what each one reflects physiologically.	PRE ①②③④⑤ POST ①②③④⑤	PRE ①②③④⑤ POST ①②③④⑤
Locate the three burner divisions of the tongue and state the Zang-Fu organs corresponding to each zone.	PRE ①②③④⑤ POST ①②③④⑤	PRE ①②③④⑤ POST ①②③④⑤
Differentiate Pale, Red, Purple, and Blue tongue-body colors and the patterns each most commonly indicates.	PRE ①②③④⑤ POST ①②③④⑤	PRE ①②③④⑤ POST ①②③④⑤
Classify body-shape findings (Thin, Swollen, Cracked, Tooth-marked, Quivering, Deviated) by the pattern each reflects.	PRE ①②③④⑤ POST ①②③④⑤	PRE ①②③④⑤ POST ①②③④⑤
Interpret tongue-coating color, thickness, and moisture to determine the state of the Yang organs, especially the Stomach.	PRE ①②③④⑤ POST ①②③④⑤	PRE ①②③④⑤ POST ①②③④⑤
Synthesize tongue-body and tongue-coating findings together to differentiate Excess from Deficiency in a clinical presentation.	PRE ①②③④⑤ POST ①②③④⑤	PRE ①②③④⑤ POST ①②③④⑤

B Activate — Connect to What You Know

B1 · From Week 3 to Today

Week 3 built your palpation skills with the 28 pulse qualities and six positions. Today shifts to the second pillar of Inspection — Tongue Diagnosis — where color, shape, coating, and moisture each tell part of the same diagnostic story the pulse was already telling you.

What do you already know about tongue diagnosis? Write whatever comes to mind — colors, coating, anything:

B2 · Connect the Dots

How might each of these earlier concepts relate to today's tongue content? Complete the connections:

Eight Principles (Week 2): Interior pattern → what tongue coating thickness and body color would you expect?

Cold vs. Heat (Week 2): Which produces a White coating and which produces Yellow? Why?

Pulse Diagnosis (Week 3): If the pulse is Slippery, what tongue coating quality would you expect to correlate?

Qi/Blood/Fluids (Week 1): A pale, swollen tongue with tooth marks points to deficiency of which Vital Substance and organ?

C Vocabulary Pre-Load — Define Before Class

Fill in your definition/mnemonic before lecture. Refine it during and after class. Blank = opportunity to learn it live.

Character	English	My Definition / Clinical Note
舌診 Shé Zhěn	Tongue Diagnosis	
舌質 Shé Zhì	Tongue Body	
舌苔 Shé Tāi	Tongue Coating	
舌尖 Shé Jiān	Tip of the Tongue	
舌根 Shé Gēn	Root of the Tongue	
胖大舌 Pàng Dà Shé	Swollen Tongue	
齒痕舌 Chǐ Hén Shé	Tooth-marked Tongue	
裂紋舌 Liè Wén Shé	Cracked Tongue	
剝苔 Bō Tāi	Peeled Coating	
舌下絡脈 Shé Xià Luò Mài	Sublingual Veins	

D Anticipatory Questions — Answer During Lecture

These questions preview exactly what the lecture will teach. Leave blank before lecture — fill in the answers as the material is covered. Come back and expand after class.

Fundamentals & Technique

Q1 · CLINICAL SIGNIFICANCE & INSPECTION ORDER ★

What four things does tongue diagnosis help a practitioner judge, distinguish, detect, and predict? What is the correct sequence for inspecting the tongue — both the region order and the body-then-coating order?

Hint: Tip → middle → root, then body → coating. Extend no longer than 15–20 seconds. Slides 241–242.

Q2 · CONDITIONS FOR EXAMINATION ★

Name at least five factors (besides the pathology itself) that can distort what you see on the tongue and produce a false reading.

Hint: Lighting, posture, food/drink, medication, season/time. Slides 243–244.

Q3 · MEDICATIONS & THE TONGUE ★★

Which medication class makes the tongue red and swollen with a peeled tip? Which can create a thick brown or black dry coating after prolonged use?

Hint: One is a steroid, one is used in chemotherapy. Slides 245–246.

Zang-Fu Correspondence & Topography

Q4 · DIVISION OF THE TONGUE & ZANG FU ★

Complete the tongue-zone table — try from memory first, then verify from the lecture:

Hint: Tip = Heart/Pericardium · Center = Spleen/Stomach · Sides = Liver/Gallbladder · Root = Kidney. Slides 246–247.

Zone	Organ(s) Reflected
Tip	
Center	
Sides	
Root	

Q5 · THREE-BURNER TOPOGRAPHY ★

Which organs occupy the anterior, middle, and posterior thirds of the tongue in the most commonly used chart?

Hint: Anterior = Heart/Pericardium/Lung · middle = Spleen/Stomach with Liver/GB at the edges · posterior = Kidney/Bladder/Intestines. Slides 247–248.

Q6 · THE THREE QI LEVELS ★★

What does the tongue coat reflect? What does the tongue body reflect? What do the sublingual veins reflect?

Hint: Wei/Defensive · Ying/Nutritive · Yuan/Constitutional Qi. Slides 251–252.

The Diagnostic Aspects

Q7 · FOUR ASPECTS PLUS ONE ★

List the four main aspects of tongue observation and the fifth “extra” one. What does each aspect indicate about the body?

Hint: Color / Shape / Coating / Moisture + Spirit. Slides 253–254.

Body Color

Q8 · NORMAL TONGUE ★

Describe a normal tongue in terms of color, coating, moisture, and sublingual veins.

Hint: Pale-red body, thin white coat, slightly moist, veins not distended. Slides 255–256.

Q9 · PALE TONGUE — YANG VS. BLOOD DEFICIENCY ★★

How do you tell Yang deficiency and Blood deficiency apart on a pale tongue, using moisture and body size?

Hint: Wet + swollen vs. dry + small/thin. Slides 257–258.

Q10 · RED TONGUE — EXCESS VS. DEFICIENCY HEAT ★★

A red tongue with a coating indicates what? A red tongue without a coating indicates what? Give one region-specific reading (tip, sides, or center).

Hint: Full-Heat vs. Empty-Heat. Slides 259–262.

Q11 · PURPLE TONGUE ★★

Purple body color always indicates _____. What is the difference between Reddish-Purple and Bluish-Purple in terms of cause?

Hint: Blood stasis; Heat origin vs. Cold origin. Slides 263–266.

Body Shape

Q12 · BODY SHAPE CONDITIONS ★★

Fill in the clinical significance of each shape during lecture:

Hint: Slides 269–272, 276–278.

Shape	Clinical Significance
Thin	
Swollen	
Stiff	
Flaccid	
Long	
Short	

Q13 · CRACKED TONGUE LOCATIONS ★★

Name the pattern indicated by a Stomach crack (central, wide), a Heart crack (midline to tip), and a Kidney crack (deep midline with small cracks).

Hint: Slides 273–274.

Q14 · TOOTH-MARKED & QUIVERING ★

Tooth-marked tongue indicates what pattern? Quivering tongue indicates what pattern?

Hint: Both point to the same organ, different mechanism. Slides 271–272.

Tongue Coating

Q15 · COATING FUNDAMENTALS ★

What organ does the coating primarily reflect? What does a thick coating always indicate, and how does thickness correlate with pathogen strength?

Hint: Stomach, with a Kidney contribution. Slides 279–282.

Q16 · COATING COLOR — WHITE, YELLOW, GRAY, BLACK ★★

What does a white coating indicate in general? Yellow? At what point does gray/black replace yellow, and what determines whether that reading is Cold or Heat?

Hint: Wet vs. dry distinguishes Cold from Heat at the darkest colors. Slides 283–290, 302–304.

Q17 · COATING THICKNESS, MOISTURE & VISCOSITY ★★

Differentiate a Moist vs. Dry coating, and a Moldy vs. Greasy coating, in terms of cause and body-fluid status.

Hint: Slides 291–298.

Q18 · COATING ROOT & PEELING ★★

What does it mean for a coating to be “rooted”? What does total absence of coating with a red tongue body indicate?

Hint: Compare to grass growing from soil. Slides 281–282, 299–301.

E Clinical Case — Apply It Before & After

Case Vignette: Mr. Alvarez, 29-year-old competitive Rumba & Cha Cha dancer

Mr. Alvarez presents with a 2-month history of fatigue, heavy limbs, and loose stools that worsen after long training days. He trains 5–6 hours daily in humid studio conditions and often skips meals, grabbing sugary drinks between run-throughs. He reports mild abdominal bloating and says his tongue “looks puffy” with visible teeth-marks along the edges when he checks it in the mirror. He denies thirst and prefers warm drinks. Examination: tongue is pale, swollen, with scalloped edges and a thin white, slightly slippery coating.

Fatigue · 2 mo

Heavy limbs

Loose stools

5–6 hr/day, humid studio

Skips meals · sugary drinks

Tongue: pale, swollen, scalloped

Thin white, slippery coat

Pre-Lecture Questions — Answer Based on Your Current Knowledge

Before the lecture, do your best with these. Guessing is fine — it primes your brain to receive the lecture material.

PRE · Q1

What tongue body color and shape would you expect to find in Mr. Alvarez, and why?

PRE · Q2

Using Eight Principles from Week 2: Interior or Exterior? Deficiency or Excess? What evidence supports your answer?

PRE · Q3

Name the pattern you suspect and the organ most directly responsible for transforming and transporting fluids.

Post-Lecture Questions — Complete After Class

POST · Q1

State the specific tongue findings (color, shape, coating, moisture) you would document for Mr. Alvarez and what each one confirms.

POST · Q2

Which body-shape sign — swelling or tooth-marks — is most diagnostic here, and what does today's lecture say it indicates?

POST · Q3

If Mr. Alvarez's coating had instead been thick, yellow, and greasy, how would your differential change?

F After-Lecture Synthesis & Self-Monitoring

Complete this section within 24 hours of lecture for maximum retention.

I Can Now Confidently...

Still Unclear — I Need to Review...

Connected to Other Learning...

Concept Map Completion — Tongue Findings by Classification

Complete the table from memory. Fill in the key findings that belong to each group and the core property or organ system each one reflects.

Classification Group	Key Findings in This Group	Core Property / Organ Reflected
Body Color		
Body Shape		
Coating Color		
Coating Quality (thickness/moisture)		
Sublingual Veins		

Homework Tracker

Assigned Homework (from lecture):

- ☐ **Task 1:** Practice tongue observation on at least 3 people (or use a mirror on yourself). Record body color, shape, coating, and moisture using the tongue map.
- ☐ **Task 2:** Complete Pulse/Tongue Journal entries — full 6-position pulse grid and tongue map on every page. Entries 1-25 due at Midterm (Aug 7).
- ☐ **Task 3:** Midterm prep — the Midterm (Aug 7) covers Journal entries 1-25 and Weeks 1-4 content. Reproduce all tongue color/shape/coating categories from memory.

Notes on practice / logistics:
